



MONTHLY UPDATE

Burundi: monthly update, August – September 2026

Edition of 2026-09-08 • 33 systems and instruments tracked

Developments summarised from sources published between the beginning of last month and today.

SUMMARY OF THE MONTH • GOVERNANCE • ICT INFRASTRUCTURE • DPI • DIGITALISATION • CAPACITY • INCLUSION
• DATA

Summary of the month

Two state systems went into production and the register underneath them did not. The revenue authority's platform [became the exclusive channel for new taxpayer registration from 4 August](#), and the instant payment system [had 17 of 78 licensed institutions live by the same date](#), with the central bank [acceded to the pan-African settlement system](#) and [expecting to join the East African cross-border network by December](#). Against them, traders at Karusi [report that electronic invoicing machines stop with every power cut](#).

Civil registration is the month's other thread and it is still a pilot. [Thirteen communes are stated to hold a biometric registration system](#), the interior ministry [puts health-facility interoperability at 123 facilities](#), and the country's own account to the African registrars states that civil registration is not yet interoperable with the digital identity it is meant to feed.

The regulator was unusually candid about the network beneath all of it: it [conceded on 3 August that quality is degraded and named six causes, four of them electricity](#), and later told a workshop that [internet use in the country is low](#) without publishing a figure. On the legislative side an [access-to-information bill](#) reached the National Assembly's [order paper](#) and [consultation opened on a law regulating social-media influencers](#).

Governance

Legislation and regulation

An [access-to-information bill](#) is on the National Assembly's [order paper for the session opened at the Kigobe Congress Palace on 3 August 2026](#). The first vice-president listed it among the bills the chamber will examine. Article 176 caps ordinary sessions at three months, putting the outer bound for passage in this sitting at roughly end-October 2026. No text, tabling number, sponsoring ministry or timetable was published and no copy is held – the announcement establishes only that the bill exists and is scheduled. Burundi has had no access-to-information statute on file to date.

The ministry opened consultations on the country's first dedicated framework for online publishing. A workshop on 26 August [gathered influencers, content creators, legal experts and jurists for sector input before a bill regulating social-media influencers and content creators is finalised](#); no draft provisions are published, and whether the law would require registration, set disclosure rules for sponsored content, create an oversight body or set penalties is unestablished.

Regional collaboration

Two regional processes opened and neither has a text. A technical team [agreed on 3 August, during the continental free-trade secretariat's mission to Bujumbura, to produce a country profile and an implementation roadmap, and consultation was held in Bujumbura on a memorandum for cross-border health-security cooperation with the regional authority](#). Neither carries a signature, a date or a funding line.

ICT Infrastructure

Connectivity

On 3 August the regulator ARCT [accepted that internet quality is degraded and named the causes](#): recurrent electricity cuts forcing base stations and data centres onto generators the operators struggle to fuel, unstable supply from the utility REGIDESO, bandwidth saturation in urban centres, ageing transmission equipment and simple absence of masts in parts of the country. It said it can apply the sanctions in operators' licence conditions, and named two remedies: a draft law enabling ICT infrastructure sharing and a PAFEN-financed mast-deployment programme. Lumitel and Econet Leo were contacted for that account and did not respond.

On the money side, the universal service fund's [revised FY2026/27 procurement plan carries BIF 11.40bn for dedicated IP transit](#) — 8 Mbit to public health facilities and 10 Mbit to schools — funded from the 1% levy on operator turnover rather than from the general budget.

Energy

Among the regulator's remedies for degraded service, named [on 3 August](#), is a planned study on powering mobile base stations.

Technical Capacity

The revenue authority's own platform went into production. From 4 August [all new taxpayer registration applications are made exclusively online, with three routes for natural persons, legal persons and cooperatives and a biometric appointment step for fingerprints and photograph](#). It is a government system entering service rather than a procurement notice, which is the rarer of the two on this ledger, and no uptime, throughput or fallback for an applicant who cannot use it is stated.

DPI

Digital Identity and CRVS

Biometric civil registration is [operating in 13 pilot communes, decentralised to zone level and interoperable with health-facility birth and death records, with a national unique identifier planned on fingerprint and facial biometrics](#). The health-facility link is the part with numbers behind it: the interior ministry says it has been [piloted since 2023, institutionalised in 2024, and now runs in 123 health facilities where it has recorded more than 52,000 births](#). No coverage denominator is given for either figure.

It is being built onto a base that already reaches most children: [84% of under-fives are registered at birth and 66% hold a birth certificate](#), cited by government on Africa Civil Registration Day. The gap between the two figures is the one the platform has to close.

Digital Payments and Fintech

Three payment rails moved. The national instant payment system, launched publicly in April, [had 17 of 78 licensed institutions live by 4 August](#), [five commercial banks and ten microfinance institutions among them](#). The central bank acceded to the pan-African payment and settlement system, with four domestic banks authorised to participate, and told the regional governors it expects to join the East African cross-border payment network by December 2026.

At the counter, none of that reaches the constraint. Traders at Karusi [report that electronic invoicing machines stop with every power cut](#), which is the same limit the regulator names for network quality.

Registries

The register, not the card, is what carries the right to vote. The electoral commission [said more than one million new voters are expected for the 2027 presidential election](#), [with partial registration planned for October 2026 in more than 4,000 centres that will also serve as polling stations](#), [targeting those under 18 at the 2025 registration and citizens returned since 2025](#), and its president said a voter who loses their card keeps the right to vote provided they are in the electoral database. That is the clearest statement this base holds of how identity works at the poll here. No register size, audit terms or duplicate-detection method is published.

The obligation behind any future social register is now on the record. An [ordinance of 7 February makes acquisition of the medical assistance card compulsory](#), [a scheme dating from 1984 and reformed in 2012](#), and the account weighs it as a step towards broader social protection. No enrolment count, card format, register or digital component is described — so what exists is a duty to hold a card, and nothing published about the system that would issue or read it.

Sectoral management information systems

The one new management system in the window sits outside the state's own stack. A [digital tool for tracking the institutional performance of Burundi's technical and vocational training centres in real time was validated on 7 August](#), built by CREOP-Jeunes under the EU-backed Umwuga Akazi project. No deployment date, centre count or custodian ministry is stated, so what the tool will be attached to is not yet on the record.

Other GovTech and e-Gov

The revenue authority's online tax platform, live since January, [became the exclusive channel for new taxpayer registrations from 4 August](#). Making a channel exclusive is the point at which a platform's availability becomes a condition of registering at all, and no fallback, uptime figure or exemption is stated.

Digitalisation

Digitalisation of sub-national government

Local government gained equipment rather than systems. A development agency [handed laptops, uninterruptible power supplies, printers and photocopiers to provincial governors and communal administrators](#), [alongside vehicles](#). It is the most direct addition to the ICT equipment held by Burundian local government offices this ledger records, and it is a donation: no count of offices reached, no maintenance arrangement and no connectivity provision accompanies it.

Rural digital data capture

Civil registration is the one rural system with a number attached to it. Marking African Civil Registration Day, the territorial administration directorate [set out digitalisation of civil status in pilot communes and decentralisation down to zone level](#), [with planned interoperability with health facilities for births and deaths notified through hill](#)

chiefs, and a UN agency stated that thirteen communes already hold a biometric registration system. Thirteen is the whole of the count: against well over a hundred communes, what the base records is a pilot that has been running for at least a quarter and a national position that has not moved.

Capacity

Training and skills

School equipment moved as procurement. A national request for proposals opened on 11 August and closed on 24 August for the supply and installation of computer equipment in 39 central schools in three former provinces, its bill of quantities naming 585 computers and uninterruptible power supplies across three lots. Set against the education ministry's own target of 760 school networks, thirty-nine schools is the increment this month records; nothing states when the equipment arrives or who maintains it.

Inclusion

Access to services

A rural community digital hub opened at Shombo. It is a single site reported by its own organisers; no programme, national count, funding line or usage figure stands behind it.

Digital divides

The telecommunications regulator told a workshop that very few Burundians use the internet. It characterised the level without publishing a figure, so the finding the base can carry is the regulator's own statement that use is low, not a percentage.

Data

National statistics

The statistical strategy reported on itself. The statutory sector statistics group met for the second quarter with the recommendations of the mid-term evaluation of the third national statistics strategy on its agenda, which establishes both that a third-generation strategy is in force and that its mid-term evaluation has reported. Neither the strategy nor the evaluation is published, so the base can date the process and cannot read what it found.

Use of satellite data

The national mapping and meteorological institute put two standing capabilities on the record. Its service page names identifying and managing agricultural, urban and protected areas among the four purposes of Burundian cartography, and states that mapping has modernised through remote sensing, satellite positioning, geographic information systems and drones, and it publishes a satellite imagery viewer whose named dynamic layers are geostationary precipitation, infrared and convection products on automatic update. Both are descriptions of what the institute does rather than dated events, and they are the first the base holds.

ABOUT THIS DOCUMENT

EDITION	2026-09-08
CURRENT EDITION	https://corpus.data-landscapers.io/reports/BDI/BDI-monthly.html
THIS FILE	https://corpus.data-landscapers.io/reports/BDI/BDI-monthly-2026-09-08.pdf
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